ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** Ruskin Bond	Ruskin Bond wrote the story.
2	**(d)** his conscience and Anil's trust	Anil's trust awakened his better self.
3	**(c)** gentle and thoughtful	It is quiet and reflective.
4	**(a)** Hari Singh	Hari Singh tells his own story.
5	**(d)** under Anil's mattress	He replaced it where he had taken it.
6	**(a)** giving Hari food, a job and a promise of learning	He helped the boy.
7	**(c)** teenage thief	He was a young thief.
8	**(d)** how trust can change a person	Anil's trust reformed Hari.
9	**(b)** the thief	Hari narrates.
10	**(b)** a wrestling match	Hari noticed Anil among the spectators.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Hari Singh was a fifteen-year-old thief (1) who narrates the story and is later reformed by Anil's trust (1).	1+1
12	He took the money Anil kept under his mattress (1) while Anil was asleep (1).	1+1
13	Anil wanted Hari to become a learned, honest person (1) by teaching him reading and writing (1).	1+1
14	He met Anil at a wrestling match (1) and hoped to win his confidence and rob him (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Hari was in the crowd at a wrestling match when he noticed Anil, a young man who looked easy to deceive. He started a friendly conversation and told a story to win sympathy. Anil responded warmly and offered him a meal and a job.	1+1+1
16	Anil's complete trust made Hari feel valued. It woke the goodness in him and changed his plan. The story shows that trust can reform where punishment may fail.	1+1+1
17	Repentant, hopeful and honest. He is repentant because he returned the money and felt ashamed of the theft.	1+1+1
	OR: Anil was a young writer who lived simply and trusted people. He was generous to a stranger and patient. He believed that a person could improve with kindness and education.	1+1+1
18	Hari lived by cheating, moving from place to place, with no education. Anil lived by writing and wished to share his learning. Their meeting brought the two ways of life together.	1+1+1
	OR: Anil told Hari that he could stay with him. 'Said to' becomes 'told'; 'can' becomes 'could'; 'you' and 'me' change to 'he' and 'him'.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Hari is a fifteen-year-old thief, skilled in winning trust (1). He first sees Anil only as a victim (1). Anil's kindness stirs his conscience (1). He returns the money and decides to learn (1). He is a young person capable of change (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date and salutation (1). His plan and the theft (1). The thoughts at the station (1). His return and relief (1). Resolve to learn from Anil (1).	2+2+1
20	Anil is a young, struggling writer (1). He is simple, trusting and generous (1). He gives a stranger a home and a job (1). He promises to teach Hari to read and write (1). His faith in goodness reforms the thief (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Hari is poor, uneducated and cunning; Anil is educated, modest and kind (1). Both are alone in the world (1). Hari mistrusts people; Anil trusts them (1). Anil changes Hari (1). Together they show how kindness works (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Hari Singh is a student; he is a **fifteen-year-old thief**, narrating in the first person, who tries to rob the writer Anil.
- Mixing Anil's response: he offers Hari **food, work and lessons**, and when Hari returns the notes Anil quietly shows he knows, without exposing him.
- Forgetting the notes episode: Hari puts the notes back under Anil's mattress; *this* is the moral turning point of the story.
- Treating money as Hari's only motive; he also wants to become a **respected, educated man**, which draws him to Anil.
- Saying Anil caught him and called the police; the story ends in **trust**, with Anil handing him a wet fifty-rupee note.
- Spelling slips: *Ruskin Bond, thief, Anil, wrestler, mattress*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** fifteen	He is a boy of about fifteen.
2	**(b)** a conscience	He felt remorse.
3	**(a)** writer	He wrote stories for a living.
4	**(a)** he first wanted to find where the money was kept	He waited for the right chance.
5	**(c)** lived simply and wrote stories	He was a struggling writer.
6	**(d)** he planned to rob him	Hari used friendly talk to win the trust of victims.
7	**(a)** easily deceived	A gullible person trusts too readily.
8	**(d)** deep regret for a wrong	Remorse is guilty regret.
9	**(d)** a cook	Hari became his cook.
10	**(c)** The money was stolen by Hari.	Past simple passive.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He wanted to take a train out of town (1) so that he would not be caught with the money (1).	1+1
12	Trust and kindness can reform even a thief (1) and education opens a path to honest living (1).	1+1
13	He offered him food and a job as his cook (1) and promised to teach him to read and write (1).	1+1
14	He thought of Anil's trust and his own wish to learn (1) and decided to go back and return the money (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Hari agreed to be his cook so that he could live in his house. He watched where Anil kept his money and waited for a night when Anil was asleep. Then he planned to take it and run.	1+1+1
16	It symbolises a new beginning. Education offers Hari a respectable career. It also shows that Anil cares for the boy's future.	1+1+1
17	Hari crept into the room, took the money from under the mattress and ran to the station.	1+1+1
	OR: Anil treated him as a friend and never doubted him. This was new to Hari, who was used to being suspected. The kindness troubled his conscience even before he stole.	1+1+1
18	Hari had been a thief from an early age and knew no other trade. He felt unworthy of kindness. But Anil's belief gave him hope that he could change.	1+1+1
	OR: Hari's conscience troubled him. He could not betray Anil's trust. Anil's kindness helped reform him.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Hari meets Anil at a wrestling match (1). Anil takes him as a cook and promises lessons (1). Hari steals the money and goes to the station (1). His conscience brings him back and he returns it (1). The story ends with Hari ready to learn (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening sentence (1). Example of Hari (1). A second chance brings hope (1). Society should offer education (1). Closing sentence (1).	2+2+1
20	Anil believes Hari is honest (1). Hari had never been trusted before (1). The trust makes him ashamed of stealing (1). He returns the money (1). Hence trust becomes the first step to reform (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Hari's own voice shows his thoughts (1). We understand his conflict (1). It makes the change believable (1). We sympathise with the thief (1). It gives a personal tone (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Hari Singh is a student; he is a **fifteen-year-old thief**, narrating in the first person, who tries to rob the writer Anil.

- Mixing Anil's response: he offers Hari **food, work and lessons**, and when Hari returns the notes Anil quietly shows he knows, without exposing him.
- Forgetting the notes episode: Hari puts the notes back under Anil's mattress; *this* is the moral turning point of the story.
- Treating money as Hari's only motive; he also wants to become a **respected, educated man**, which draws him to Anil.
- Saying Anil caught him and called the police; the story ends in **trust**, with Anil handing him a wet fifty-rupee note.
- Spelling slips: *Ruskin Bond, thief, Anil, wrestler, mattress*.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** Hari's chance to escape	It was his escape route.
2	**(a)** trusting and kind	He treated the boy generously.
3	**(d)** dishonest	Dishonest = not truthful.
4	**(a)** Anil said that he would teach him.	Pronoun and tense change.
5	**(a)** to read and write	Education was his gift.
6	**(c)** a sudden sharp feeling	Pang = sudden pain or feeling.
7	**(c)** faith	Trust means firm belief in someone.
8	**(a)** to the railway station	He meant to leave town by train.
9	**(a)** simple past	Trusted is simple past.
10	**(a)** to learn and live honestly	He accepts Anil's offer of lessons.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He knows how to charm strangers (1) and picks people who can be tricked (1).	1+1
12	Anil was a kind and trusting man (1) and judged Hari by his friendly manner, not by his past (1).	1+1
13	He crept back to Anil's room (1) and slid the money under the mattress from where he had taken it (1).	1+1
14	It is told by the thief in the first person (1) and records his change from thief to learner (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He remembered Anil's trust and the promise to teach him to read and write. He felt ashamed that he had betrayed such a friend. He wondered whether he would ever get another chance in life.	1+1+1
16	The story takes place in a small Indian town with a wrestling ground, Anil's modest room and a railway station. These simple settings suit the quiet tale and Hari's night journey.	1+1+1
17	A person is not born a thief; circumstances shape him. Kindness and education can change life. Never give up on another person.	1+1+1
	OR: His conscience troubled him. He valued Anil's trust and his offer of lessons more than the stolen money. He decided to return and put it back.	1+1+1
18	Hari agreed to cook for Anil as part of his plan. He tried to please him by preparing meals. Anil appreciated his work, which added to Hari's feelings of guilt.	1+1+1
	OR: At the start Hari is a cunning thief who plans to rob a kind man. At the end he is a repentant boy who returns the money and hopes to study. Anil's trust causes the change.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Anil falls asleep (1). Hari finds the money under the mattress (1). He leaves quietly and goes to the station (1). He thinks about Anil and returns (1). He puts the money back and feels relief (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Correct format (1). Anil notices nothing or smiles (1). Hari hints at his repentance (1). Anil says lessons will start (1). Warm ending (1).	2+2+1
20	Hari cannot read or write and so has few honest options (1). Anil offers to teach him (1). Education gives self-respect (1). It can end a life of crime (1). It is the story's hope for his future (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Redemption means being saved from wrong (1). Hari's theft shows his old self (1). His return of the money shows his new self (1). Anil's trust is the means (1). The story ends hopefully (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Hari Singh is a student; he is a **fifteen-year-old thief**, narrating in the first person, who tries to rob the writer Anil.

- Mixing Anil's response: he offers Hari **food, work and lessons**, and when Hari returns the notes Anil quietly shows he knows, without exposing him.
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